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🚀 README to RTF — Auto-Convert GitHub READMEs to Rich Documents 🎉

> **Your README.md, beautifully rendered as a shareable RTF file — automatically, on every push.**

```
README.md  ──▶  README.rtf  ──▶  Open anywhere. Share with anyone.
```

✨ **Embedded Images** | :art: **Syntax-Highlighted Code Blocks** | :link: **Clickable Links & Footnotes** | ⚠️ **GitHub Alerts** | 📝 **Full GFM Support** | 🚀 **Emoji That Actually Render**

Why?

GitHub READMEs look great *on GitHub*. But what about:

- :briefcase: **Sharing with non-developers** who don't have GitHub accounts?
- :page_facing_up: **Attaching to proposals, grants, or reports** that need a real document?
- :airplane: **Reading offline** without a browser?
- :printer: **Printing** with proper formatting?

This project auto-generates a **rich, formatted RTF file** from your `README.md` every time you push. The RTF opens in LibreOffice, Word, WordPad, TextEdit — any word processor on any OS.

What You Get

Feature	Status
Headings (h1-h6) with sizes	☑
Bold, *italic*, ~~strikethrough~~	☑
Clickable hyperlinks	☑
Internal document links (section anchors)	☑
`@mention` links to GitHub profiles	☑
`#issue` links to repo issues	☑
Fenced code blocks with **syntax highlighting**	☑
Inline code with background shading	☑
Embedded images with auto-scaling	☑
Oversized image clamping to page bounds	☑
Tables with borders	☑
Ordered, unordered, and task lists	☑

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GitHub alerts (Note, Tip, Important, Warning, Caution)	☑
Blockquotes	☑
Footnotes with clickable references	☑
Emoji via surrogate pairs	☑
Horizontal rules	☑

Quick Start

1. Copy the action into your repo

```
mkdir -p .github/actions/readme-to-rtf
cp action.yml gfm_markdown_to_rtf.py rtf_image_embedder.py
.github/actions/readme-to-rtf/
```

2. Add the workflow

Create `.github/workflows/readme-to-rtf.yml`:

```yaml
name: Convert README to RTF

on:
  workflow_dispatch:
  push:
    paths:
      - 'README.md'

jobs:
  convert:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    permissions:
      contents: write
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4

      - name: Convert README to RTF
        uses: ./.github/actions/readme-to-rtf

      - name: Configure git
        shell: bash
        run: git config user.name "github-actions[bot]"

      - name: Configure git email
        shell: bash
        run: git config user.email "github-actions[bot]@users.noreply.github.com"

      - name: Stage RTF
        shell: bash
        run: git add README.rtf
```

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```
      - name: Commit if changed
        shell: bash
        run: 'git diff --cached --quiet || git commit -m "auto-regenerate README.rtf
from README.md"'

      - name: Push
        shell: bash
        run: git push
```

3. Push and done

Every time `README.md` changes, the workflow generates a fresh `README.rtf` and commits it to your repo. You can also trigger it manually from the Actions tab.

How It Works

Two Python scripts, zero heavy dependencies:

1. **`gfm_markdown_to_rtf.py`** — Parses GitHub-Flavored Markdown and generates RTF with a data-driven rule engine. Uses Pygments for syntax highlighting. Resolves `@mentions` and `#issues` to GitHub URLs automatically.
2. **`rtf_image_embedder.py`** — Standalone module that finds `[Image: ...]` placeholders in RTF, reads the referenced local images, downscales them to fit page bounds using Pillow, and embeds them as hex-encoded `ESC:` blocks.

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Dependencies

- **Python 3** (preinstalled on GitHub Actions runners)
- **Pygments** (`pip install pygments`) — syntax highlighting for 500+ languages
- **Pillow** (`pip install pillow`) — image processing for embedding and downscaling

Run Locally

```
pip install pygments pillow
python3 gfm_markdown_to_rtf.py README.md README.rtf
python3 rtf_image_embedder.py README.rtf
```

Viewing Tips

When opening the RTF in LibreOffice Writer:

- **Disable red squiggles**: Tools > Automatic Spell Checking (toggle off)
- **Read-only mode**: Edit > Edit Mode (toggle off) for a clean reading view
- **Full screen**: `Ctrl+Shift+J`

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:test_tube: Test Content

> Everything below exercises every GitHub-Flavored Markdown element supported by the converter. The generated `README.rtf` in this repo is living proof it all works — open it and compare!

Heading Level 2

Heading Level 3

Heading Level 4

Heading Level 5

Heading Level 6

Text Formatting

This is **bold text** and this is **also bold**. This is *italic text* and this is *also italic*. This is ***bold and italic*** together. This is ~~strikethrough text~~. This is $_{\text{subscript}}$ and this is ^{superscript}. This is <u>underlined</u> text.

Escaped special characters: {*not italic} and #not a heading.*

Line break with two trailing spaces:
This is on the next line.

Line break with backslash:
This is also on the next line.

And a
hard break via HTML.

Links

Here is an inline link and a link to a section.

Here is a relative link to another file.

Bare URL autolink: https://github.com

GitHub references: @octocat and issue #42.

Images

Standard markdown image (no size control):

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HTML image with custom width:

HTML image with custom height only (width should auto-calculate from aspect ratio):

HTML image with custom width and height:

HTML image with percentage width:

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Picture element for light/dark theme variants:

Large wide image (should be clamped to page width):

Large tall image (should be clamped to page height):

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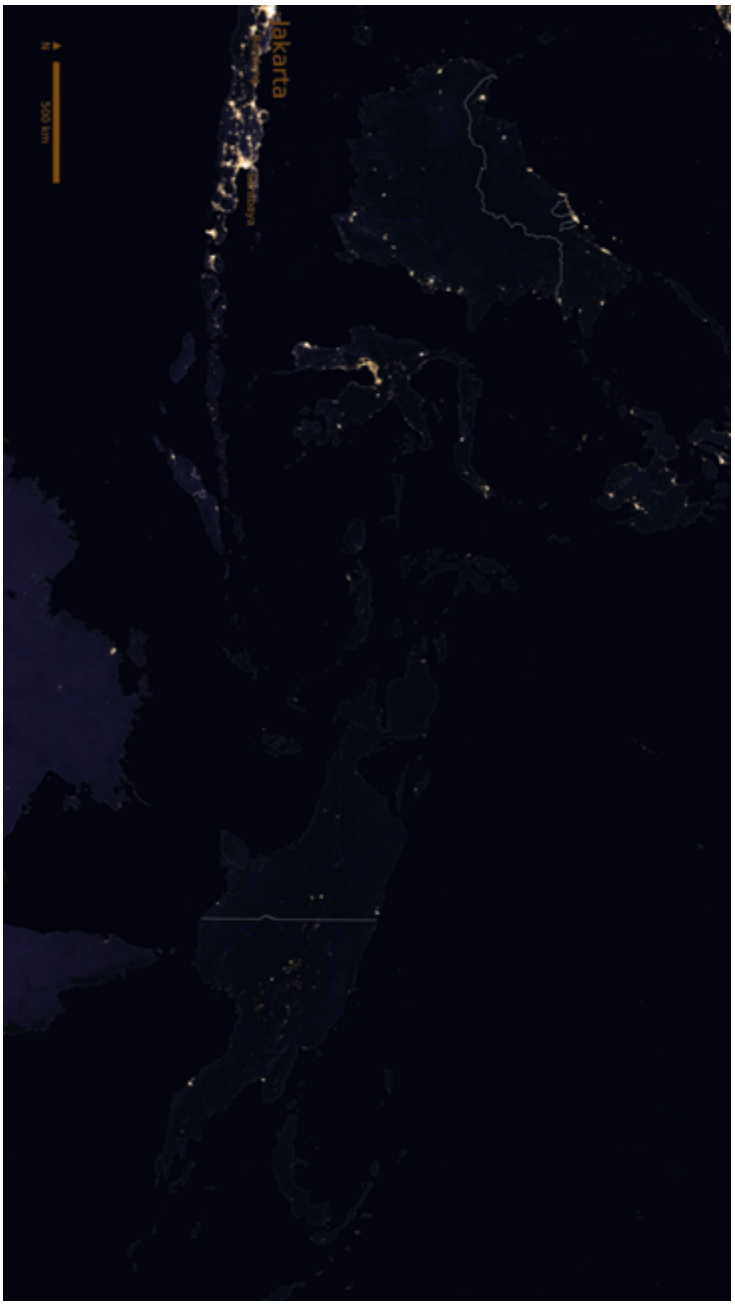

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le Format APIs

Blockquotes

> This is a blockquote.
> It can span multiple lines.
>
> This is a nested blockquote with actual content inside it.

Alerts

Note

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This is a note alert with helpful information.

Tip

This is a tip alert with a suggestion.

Important

This is an important alert.

Warning

This is a warning alert.

Caution

This is a caution alert.

Unordered Lists

- First item
- Second item
  - Nested item A
  - Nested item B
    - Deeply nested item
- Third item

Alternative markers:

- Star item one
- Star item two
- Plus item one
- Plus item two

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Ordered Lists

1. First step
2. Second step
   1. Sub-step A
   2. Sub-step B
3. Third step

Task Lists

- [x] Completed task
- [ ] Incomplete task
- [x] Another done task
  - [ ] Nested incomplete subtask
  - [x] Nested complete subtask

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Inline Code

Use the `println()` function to print output. The config file is at `~/.config/app.json`.

Fenced Code Blocks

```
fun main() {
    val greeting = "Hello, World!"
    println(greeting)
}


<uses-permission android:name="android.permission.INTERNET" />


#!/bin/bash
echo "No language-specific highlighting"


Plain code block with no language specified.
```

Tables

Feature	Status	Notes
Bold	Supported	Uses `**text**`
Italic	Supported	Uses `*text*`
Tables	Supported	You're looking at one

Left, center, and right alignment:

Left	Center	Right
L1	C1	R1
L2	C2	R2

Horizontal Rules

Footnotes

Here is a sentence with a footnote reference [1] . And another [longnote] .

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Emoji

Emoji shortcodes: `:rocket:` 🚀, `:tada:` 🎉, `:warning:` ⚠️

Color Codes

GitHub renders color swatches for these inline code formats:

`#FF5733` `#28A745` `rgb(54, 95, 145)` `hsl(210, 45%, 39%)`

HTML Comments

This document was truncated here because it was created in the Evaluation Mode.

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